DRAFT : Self Assessment Questions for Primary Schools

Question	Answer	Comment	Other
Which year group do you want to consider? - do you already know how our chosen cultural setting/collection might enhance your KS requirements/targets?		Projects have so far run for children aged 4 - 10 yrs.	
Have you thought what time of year you would like to run the project in? - can this take best advantage of the setting? - maybe a quieter time for the venue? - a quieter term for the children might mean that the project becomes highlight in the year		The bulk of the projects have run in the Spring/early Summer so far, although a joint Botanic Garden/Nursery project (Cambridge) ran in the autumn	
How will you get to the museum/ cultural venue? - can the children walk? - can parents take and fetch? - can you use public transport? - do you need to think of a school bus?		We suggest maximum travel time of 20 minutes each way. Walking; Public Transport and School Bus can all be used as exciting extra learning opportunities! (health/ wellbeing; neighbourhood context; real life learning etc.)	

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What do you truly need in a class room base? - tables and chairs - storage - blackboard/whiteboard - wi-fi? - display opportunities etc. Can you use the opportunity for an exciting new sort of classroom?		Remember you will be given lots of new spaces to work in throughout the museum/ cultural setting; inside and outside! The success of the projects to die partly comes from being in a DIFFERENT, more memorable environment.	
What is your starting point or “shopping list” of stand-out museum objects or themed areas of the Collection/cultural setting to use?		How does the Collection fit your current idea of projects and topics? New ideas are guaranteed to occur on site once you start!	
How can you make best use of additional museum/cultural setting resources? - museum learning officers’ (MLO) knowledge, stories and experience? - existing “packages” of learning information provided by the venue? - bespoke activities to be discussed and agreed with venue staff?		Create a coordinated structure of additional “events” through your lesson plans. Projects to date shared how, once started, ideas and additional opportunities snowballed!	

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How much of the week must you structure? How much of the week can you leave open to see how the children are inspired and start to curate their experience themselves?		Projects to date have shown that if you have the confidence to be more relaxed and flexible in your approach, curriculum boxes will be “ticked” faster than you think! Often simply led by the children’s own interests and inspiration out of their school classroom	